

Dr Paddy Tobias

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About Me

I am a senior data scientist and technical lead with over 10 years' experience delivering complex survey analysis and evidence-based insights in public-sector and research environments. I specialise in applying advanced analytics using R and Python to large, longitudinal survey datasets to support system performance monitoring, policy development, and executive decision-making.



My background includes leading analytical projects end-to-end – from data quality assurance and methodology through to reporting, dashboards, and stakeholder briefings – with a strong focus on clarity, rigour, and data governance. I am experienced in working with external partners, managing competing priorities, and translating complex findings into clear, actionable insights for senior leaders and external stakeholders.

[Read more about me here...](#)

Current Position

DataOps Manager - The Social Research Centre

2024-present

- Lead a team of 15 analysts and data scientists, covering the full data lifecycle of the SRC's projects.
- Lead complex **survey analytics and data delivery** across multiple high-stakes, government-facing research programs, with hands-on responsibility for analytical quality, methodology, and reporting outputs.
- Undertake and oversee **advanced analysis of large survey datasets** using R, Python, and SQL, supporting both routine reporting and bespoke analytical requests.
- Translate complex analytical findings into **clear reports, briefings, and presentations** for internal executives, clients, and external stakeholders.
- Provide technical leadership across a multidisciplinary team of analysts and data scientists, ensuring analytical consistency, quality assurance, and adherence to data governance standards.
- Drive improvements in **survey data validation, schema enforcement, and reproducibility**, increasing confidence in published results and dashboards.
- Work closely with project managers, suppliers, and stakeholders to support **survey operations, timelines, and delivery**.
- Contribute directly to client research projects, acting as a senior analytical resource on survey design, data interpretation, and methodological risk.

Relevant focus areas

- **Survey analytics:** longitudinal analysis, performance indicators, outcome measures
- **Data quality assurance:** validation frameworks, reproducible workflows, audit trails
- **Reporting & briefing:** executive-ready analysis, stakeholder presentations
- **Governance & privacy:** secure handling of sensitive survey data

Data Science Manager – The Social Research Centre

2021-2024

- Managed and contributed to analytical delivery for large-scale government survey programs, including the **Quality Indicators for Learning and Teaching (QILT)** project.
- Led teams delivering **parallel end-to-end survey processes**, ensuring analytical accuracy, consistency, and on-time reporting.
- Provided expert advice to researchers and senior stakeholders on **survey methodology, data interpretation, and analytical risk**.
- Oversaw multiple concurrent analytical projects, balancing operational reporting with deeper exploratory and evaluative analysis.

Senior Data Scientist - The Social Research Centre

2019-2021

As senior data scientist, I worked on the Major Projects team for the SRC. The main focus is the [QILT](<https://www.qilt.edu.au/>) project for the Australian Government Department of Education, Skills and Employment.

QILT is a longitudinal study into student experience and outcomes of high education students in Australia, which has been running for over ten years.

I started as a data scientist in 2019 and was promoted to a senior position less than a year later.

Selected other experience

eResearch Analyst, Deakin University - Intersect Australia

2018-2019

Based at Deakin University, Burwood, reporting to the Director of the eResearch team. My role was to service researcher at the the Burwood campus, including coordinating training, providing strategic support for faculties, and supporting researchers to incorporate computational techniques into their workflow.

► **Click** to see a selection of activities

eResearch Analyst, University of New England - Intersect Australia

2016-2018

Based at UNE, reporting to the Deputy Vice Chancellor - Research (DVCR). Whilst located in the Research Services Directorate, to carry out this role effectively, I worked collaboratively with the University Library and the IT Directorate, as well as the faculties.

► **Click** to see a selection of activities

Research Fellow, Institute of Conflict Transformation and Social Justice, Queen's University (Belfast)

2014

Lead Monitoring & Evaluation Consultant, Women's Empowerment and Access to Justice project in Timor-Leste, Search for Common Ground (Washington)

2013

Education

M.Data Science. University of New England, *2018-on-hold*

Ph.D, *Cum laude*. University of New England, 2010-2015

B.International Relations, *Distinction*. Deakin University, 2007-2009

Other training

Databricks training, 2025

Advanced R Shiny, 2022

R package development, 2020

Software Carpentry instructor accreditation, 2018

Technical Skills

My proficiency in selected ETL tools

R, Shiny app development, package development

Databricks and Apache Spark (PySpark and SparkR)

Python 2 and 3

SQL (SQLite, Oracle, Postgres and MySQL) and database design

Git, GitHub, CI/CD, GH Copilot, and version control standards

Bash, grep, sed

Javascript

Publications

[Read about them here...](#)

References

Provided on request.

paddytobias.github.io

paddytobias@me.com